Armen G. Kaprelian

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Education

Claremont Graduate University 2022 – Expected 2026
Ph.D., Economics (GPA: 3.88) *Claremont, CA*

- Dissertation: *Opacity and Adaptation under Sanctions: Geoeconomics in the Universe of Russian Firms*
- Among the first firm-level sanctions studies with universal administrative coverage of a target economy: ∼63M firm-years across ∼10M Russian firms (2011–2025), processed in R on AWS and Google Colab. Financial statements include balance sheets, profit and loss statements, cash flow statements, and statements of changes in equity.
- Methods: Logit models of statement availability with industry, region, legal-form, ownership, and year FE. Industry/region SE clustering. Registry transition accounting and 100 km equal-area maps. Event-study design: PPML for real revenue and OLS for operating margin in fixed baseline cohorts, with firm, industry-year, and region-year FE. IPW for selective observation, bounded missing-outcome stress tests, quantile DiD, and CatBoost.
- Trade projects (2024): Assessed how a proposed 60% U.S. tariff on Chinese imports might affect bilateral exports using gravity regressions and LightGBM (∼1.3M CEPII panel observations). Queried UN Comtrade's API for bilateral imports to track centrality in a 15-country network around the 2022 sanctions on Russia. Modeled reciprocal ties (TERGM).
- Fields: geoeconomics, political economy, international trade, sanctions and counter-sanctions

George Mason University 2018 – 2020
M.A., Economics (GPA: 3.70) *Arlington, VA*

Arizona State University (Honors College) 2012 – 2016
B.S., Economics (GPA: 3.89) *Tempe, AZ*

Experience

Ministry of Economy of the Republic of Armenia Sep 2020 – Jul 2022
Economic Research Assistant, Economic Research Center *Yerevan, Armenia*

- Co-authored the quarterly *Armenian Economic Outlook* used by Fitch Ratings to assess Armenia's sovereign rating.
- Tracked shifts to other foreign suppliers under Armenia's embargo on Turkish goods (∼1,000 six-digit HS categories, UN Comtrade, 2018–2021) and forecast monthly imports from Turkey using seasonal ARIMA. Prices for covered imports from outside Turkey rose 26% from 2020 to 2021, versus ∼6% for the same basket across six trading partners.
- Wrote a March 2022 report assessing Armenia's exposure to sanctions on Russia through trade, remittances, and banking. Drew on the 2014–15 episode, when Armenian exports to Russia fell 38%.
- Estimated Armenia's incremental capital-output ratio (∼2.3) and a ∼$1B national capital-investment gap benchmarked against 11 peer economies, informing policymaker guidance.
- Modeled the fiscal effects of a proposed 6% payroll-tax health-insurance mandate via domestic consumption functions and shadow-economy dynamics, projecting an annual budget cost near 4% of GDP.

Center for International Private Enterprise (CIPE) Sep 2019 – Dec 2019
Research Intern, Eastern Europe & Eurasia Department *Washington, DC*

- Authored a 90-page report comparing small-business financing barriers and anti-corruption rules across 11 countries.
- Presented a climate plan to senior staff. Studied auctions for renewables and blended finance to draw private capital.

Armenian Assembly of America Jun 2019 – Aug 2019
Research Intern, Office of the Nagorno-Karabakh Republic *Washington, DC*

- Analyzed renewable energy and banking for investors and harmonized regional economic and financial data.

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics with Linear Algebra (R, Python), Pomona College Jan 2025 – May 2025
Teaching Assistant, Econometrics II: Causal Inference (R, Stata), Claremont Graduate University Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

Skills & Languages

Programming R, Python, Stata, SQL, LaTeX
Computing Linux, AWS, Google Colab; DuckDB and Parquet; Git and GitHub
Software Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, Word
Languages English (native), Armenian (conversational)

Fellowships

- **Economics Fellowship**, Claremont Graduate University, 2022–present.
- **H. Hovnanian Family Foundation Public Service Fellowship**, 2021: continued government service after iGorts.
- **iGorts Fellowship**, 2020: selected to serve in the Armenian government.